2.3 Acute Pain

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The pain is sharp and does not go away." • Scores the pain 7/10 **Objective** • Guards the painful area • Restless and grimacing • HR 106/min, RR 22/min	**ACTUAL** **Acute pain** related to physical injury agent as evidenced by pain score 7/10, guarding and increased HR.	Pain 3/10 or less within 1 hour of the intervention. Able to rest and join in with his care.	• Ask where the pain is, how bad it is, what it feels like and how long it lasts. • Give analgesics as prescribed and check again after 30–60 minutes. • Support the painful area in a comfortable position. • Use cold or warm packs if ordered. • Teach relaxation and slow breathing. • Take the patient's word for the pain, and write it down.	Pain at 3/10 or less: **goal met**. If not, go over the analgesic regimen with the physician.
Subjective • "I wake up because of the pain." • Says he sleeps about 3 hours a night **Objective** • Yawning, dark circles under the eyes • Irritable	**ACTUAL** **Disturbed sleep pattern** related to pain as evidenced by frequent waking and reported short sleep.	Sleeping at least 5 hours a night within 2 nights.	• Give analgesia before bed. • Keep noise and lights down at night. • Bunch care together so he gets longer stretches of rest. • Let him keep his usual bedtime routine.	Says he slept 5–6 hours: **goal met**. If not, look again at how well his pain is controlled at night.
Subjective • No bowel movement for 2 days **Objective** • On opioid analgesics • Moving less than usual	**RISK** **Risk for constipation** as evidenced by risk factors: opioid use and reduced physical activity.	Passes soft stool at least every 2–3 days.	• Chart bowel movements every day. • Unless fluids are restricted, aim for 2–2.5 L/day. • Encourage fibre in the diet, and as much movement as he can manage. • Give the prescribed stool softener or laxative alongside the opioid.	Soft stool every 2 days: **goal met**. No stool for 3 days, or a distended abdomen, needs reporting.